

A blue-tinted photograph of a hand holding a smartwatch. The watch screen displays '101' at the top, 'FACTORY RHYTHM' below it, and '0:00:00' at the bottom. The hand is positioned with the thumb pointing towards the watch. A yellow star icon is placed above the thumb. The background is blurred, showing other people's hands.

The Player-Coach Playbook

M.V.P.  Accelerator™
POWERED BY ATHLEADERSHIP ARENA™



Lesson 1

Suit Up - Your Leadership M.V.P.



“The foundation of every great team is a clear, committed partnership between the player and the Player-Coach.”



Drill 1.1

Pre-Game Huddle: Your Focus for Lesson 1

(This drill corresponds to Video Topic 1.1)



Instructions:

Welcome to your first week, Player-Coach. This week is about laying the foundation for a successful 10-week season by establishing:

Alignment

Before you begin, this drill helps you anchor your focus in the growth you identified in your pre-program assessment.

► Your Objectives for this Lesson:

- » Understand your role as a Player-Coach in the Athleadership model.
- » Define your own “Player-Coach Intention” with a focus on your wellbeing and leadership growth.
- » Identify a key “Player-Coach Multiplier” opportunity with your Athleader.
- » Facilitate a structured “Commient Meeting” to create a foundation of trust and clarity.



Action

Ground Your Intention.

Review the two questions you reflected on at the start of this lesson. Keep them front and center as you complete these drills to ensure your work is targeted and meaningful.

- » *What is one leadership behavior you want to strengthen for yourself?*
- » *What is one leadership behavior you want to improve in how you support your team’s performance?*

A.R.A.W. Conditioning Drills



Drill 1.2

LEAD SELF — Define Your Player-Coach Intention

(This drill corresponds to Video Topic 1.2)



Instructions:

Great coaching starts with self-awareness. Before you can guide your Athleader, you need to know what you want out of this experience for your own growth. This is your first step in leading yourself (**Alignment** and **Well-being**), so you can more effectively lead others.

Reflection & Action

1

Identify Your Pressure Point:

Identify Your Pressure Point: What is one specific pressure point (e.g., tight deadlines, team conflict, managing up) you are currently facing in your role? *(This helps you focus on a real-world challenge where you can apply what you are learning immediately.)*



My Response

2 Define Your Well-being Practice

What is one well-being practice (e.g., taking a 15-minute walk at lunch, ending the workday at a set time, delegating one task) you can implement this week to manage that pressure and perform sustainably? *(This is your first A.R.A.W. check-in, connecting well-being directly to performance.)*

 My Response

3 State Your Intention

Combine your reflections into a single, powerful intention statement. *(This intention will be your anchor for the next 10 weeks, and you will share it with your Athleader.)*

 My intention for this M.V.P. Accelerator season is to



Great leaders
don't wait for
change - they
create it.

Drill 1.3

LEAD OTHERS — Identify the Multiplier Effect

(This drill corresponds to Video Topic 1.3)



Instructions:
Your leadership is a catalyst. This drill helps you strategically focus your coaching on the area where your Athleader’s growth will have the biggest ripple effect on the team and business, maximizing the “Player-Coach Multiplier Effect.”

Reflection & Action

1 Identify a Growth Area

What is one area of growth for your Athleader (e.g., technical skill, presentation skills, cross-functional collaboration) that, if improved, would have the largest positive impact on the rest of the team?



My Response

2 Connect to a Business Goal

How does this growth area connect to one of your team’s key business goals for this quarter?
(This creates clear alignment between individual development and business outcomes.)



My Response

3 Align with Stakeholders

How could you align stakeholders outside of your immediate team to support this goal? Have you translated direction from your senior leaders into clear, actionable steps for your team related to this? *(This drill links to the survey theme of organizational alignment and ensuring your team understands the “why” behind their work.)*



My Response

LEAD OTHERS — The First Conversation Playbook

(This drill corresponds to Video Topic 1.4)



Instructions:

This meeting is the single most important play call of this lesson. It moves your relationship from one of unspoken assumptions to one of explicit, aligned partnership. Use this detailed playbook to structure the conversation.



Action

Agenda & Talking Points

1 Opening: The Dual Journey (5 mins)

Player-Coach: “Thanks for meeting. I’m excited to go on this journey with you as a partnership. While you’re going through the

Athleader track, I’m going through this Player-Coach track to become a better Player-Coach for you and the team.”

2 Sharing Intentions (10 mins)

Ask Your Athleader: “In your first lesson, you set a ‘Championship Season Intention.’ I’d love to hear what that is. What is the most important transformation you’re aiming for?”

now?” or “What would achieving that unlock for you?”

Listen Intently. Ask clarifying questions like, “What makes that so important to you right

Share Your Intention: “Thank you for sharing. My intention as your Player-Coach is [Share your intention from Drill 1.2]. I’m sharing this because I want us to hold each other accountable and be partners in this growth.”

“I am a manager who manages several participants.”

Great. This journey supports your growth and your team’s. If you manage multiple participants, hold one 30-minute Commitment Meeting with each person at the start. After that, build the 15-minute check-ins into your existing meeting rhythm. No need to create additional meetings.

3 Defining a “Win” & Setting a Cadence (5 mins)

Co-Create a Vision: “Looking ahead 10 weeks, what does a huge ‘win’ look like for both of us as a result of this program?”

this program. This will be our dedicated time to connect on your progress. Let’s get it on the calendar now.”

Set the Rhythm: “Let’s set up a recurring [weekly 15-minute] check-in specifically for

4 Agreeing on Support & Psychological Safety (10 mins)

Ask for Needs: “What is the most important thing you need from me to feel supported and safe to take risks on this journey?” (This question directly addresses the core competency of creating psychological safety, a key theme in your survey.)

State Your Needs: “To be the best Player-Coach I can be for you, what I need is [e.g., for you to be proactive in sharing your insights, for you to be open when you face a challenge]. This will help us build a strong foundation of trust.”



My Response

Locker Room Reflection

(This reflection corresponds to the Real-World Challenge from Video Topic 1.4)

Challenge: During your commient meeting, your Athleader seems hesitant and gives very general answers about their goals. How do you apply the principle of **psychological safety** to encourage openness without applying pressure? What specific question could you ask to build trust?